government in an alliance that includes two Communist Parties and several others.

1967: Jan Sangh wins thirty-five Lok Sabha seats, crossing an important threshold.

1968: Deen Dayal Upadhyaya killed in a train under mysterious circumstances.

- Atal Bihari Vajpayee becomes Jan Sangh president.

IV. A Pre-history of Demonetisation

19 July 1969: Indira Gandhi nationalises the fourteen largest commercial banks in India; Jan Sangh responds with an economic policy document that does not oppose it in principle, only the form of implementation. Passes economic resolution urging takeover of all big foreign firms.

12 February 1971: Future BJP prime minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee, as Jan Sangh president, says he will implement demonetisation to eliminate black money if voted to power.

- Vajpayee also pushes for swadeshi products, like in the days before Independence; says imperative to revive local products and ‘people are getting crazy over imported things and even pay fabulous prices for them’.
- Vajpayee further demands exemption from all income tax for those earning up to ₹7,500, following the recommendations of the Boothalingam Committee; argues for ‘heavy consumer tax’ on ‘luxuries’ like refrigerators, transistors, fans and the like.
- Future prime minister I.K. Gujral, then a Congress Rajya Sabha MP, had earlier demanded demonetisation on 18 November 1964.
- On 3 July 1967, the Uttar Pradesh cabinet, including Jan Sangh ministers in an alliance government led by Charan Singh, had also passed a cabinet resolution demanding that the Central government demonetise all notes above ₹10.